

Surili Sheth

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Academic Position

ETH Zurich

Oct. 2025–Present

ETH Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences (D-GESS)

Education

University of California, Berkeley

2025

Ph.D. in Political Science

Dissertation: *The Politics of Disclosure: Three Papers on the Dynamics of Domestic Violence Claim-Making in India*

Committee: Pradeep Chhibber and Thad Dunning (co-chairs), Cecilia Mo, and Jennifer Bussell

University of California, Berkeley

2020

M.A. in Political Science

Harvard Kennedy School

2015

Master in Public Administration/International Development (MPA/ID)

The Ohio State University

2011

B.S. in Economics (Honors) and Political Science (Honors), summa cum laude; Minor in Mathematics

Research Interests

Comparative Politics; Political Economy of Development; State Capacity and Legal Institutions; Legal Mobilization; Gender-Based Violence; Immigration; South Asia; United States; Quantitative Methods; Qualitative Methods

Job Market Paper

The Dependency Trap: Domestic Violence and Claim-Making in India

Presented at: EGEN Stanford (2026); PolMeth Europe (2026); EMPESA Oslo (2026); EGEN Bergen (2026); EPSS Belfast (2026)

Working Papers

Missing and Miscoded Women: The Institutional Trajectories of Domestic Violence Claims

Presented at: WPSA (2026); MPSA (2026)

Do Virtual Museums Highlighting the Experiences of Minorities Persuade Visitors? Evidence from a Study on Bias Toward Asian Americans

With Charles Crabtree, John B. Holbein, and Cecilia Mo. *Under review.* Available on SSRN.

Presented at: MPSA (2026)

Forever Foreign? Differential Linguistic Assimilation Standards for Asian Immigrants

With Charles Crabtree, John B. Holbein, and Cecilia Mo.

Commonality or Difference? Sexual Assault and the Foundations of Women's Solidarities in the United States

Projects in Progress

Substitution Within Carceral Systems: Local Prison Capacity, Sanctuary Cities, and Immigrant Detention in the United States

Rooted in Rights: Women's Bargaining Power on Forest Land

With Bhumi Purohit and Rashi Sabherwal. *Funded by ETH4D Development Challenge Pilot Grant.*

A Room of One's Own: Physical Infrastructure, Identity, and Access to Justice in Rural North India

With Anjali Bohlken and Debabrata Samanta. *Funded by ETH Fellowship Research Grant and joint funding.*

Reviews, Policy Reports, and Other Writing

Women's Economic Empowerment in Pakistan: An Evidence-Guided Toolkit for More Inclusive Policies

With Sofia Amaral, Pulkit Aggarwal, Anusha Guha, Osama Safeer, and Shirleen Manzur. South Asia Gender Innovation Lab, World Bank, 2024. Report.

Book review of *Performing Representation: Women Members in the Indian Parliament*, by Shirin M. Rai and Carole Spary, and *Women, Power, and Property: The Paradox of Gender Equality Laws in India*, by Rachel E. Brulé

Seminar, no. 752, "She Rules!" (April 2022).

Seeing Like the State or Seeing the State? The Political Economy of Women's Self-Help Groups in Madhya Pradesh

With Arundhita Bhanjdeo, Nivedita Narain, and Michael Walton. Harvard Kennedy School working paper.

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

ETH4D Research Challenge Pilot Grant (\$24,500)	2026–2027
ETH Postdoctoral Research Fellowship, Research Fund (\$24,500)	2025–2027
Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Dissertation Fellowship (\$38,000)	2022
Dissertation Grant, Center on Contemporary India, UC Berkeley (\$15,000)	2022
APSA Minority Fellowship (\$2,000)	2019
3ie Grant for Qualitative Study on Sustainability of Self-Help Groups under the National Rural Livelihoods Mission (\$91,960)	2019
Center for Race and Gender Research Grant, UC Berkeley (\$2,000)	2019
Research Grant, Institute of International Studies, UC Berkeley (\$2,000)	2019
Center for the Politics of Development Grant, UC Berkeley (\$20,000)	2018–2023
Mossavar-Rahmani Center for Business and Government Winter Grant, Harvard Kennedy School	2015
Degree Student Program Winter Grant for Second Year Policy Analysis, Harvard Kennedy School	2015
International Development Grant, Harvard Kennedy School	2014
John F. Kennedy Full Tuition Fellowship, Harvard Kennedy School	2013–2015

Teaching

South Asian Politics	Fall 2024
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Pradeep Chhibber; undergraduate-level</i>	
Quantitative Analysis in Political Research - Causal Inference	Fall 2020
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Thad Dunning; Ph.D.-level</i>	
Gender and International Human Rights	Spring 2020, 2021
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Helene Silverberg; undergraduate-level</i>	
The Varieties of Capitalism: The Political-Economic Systems of the World	Fall 2019
<i>Graduate Student Instructor for Steven Vogel; undergraduate-level</i>	

Affiliations and Service to Field

Reviewer for <i>Perspectives on Politics</i>	
Research Supervisor , Graduate Student Researcher, ETH Zurich	Sept. 2026–Present
Prospective Applicant Mentor , Equity in Policy Education	2021–2023
Research Supervisor , Center for the Politics of Development Fellowship	2020–2021; 2022–2023
Representative , Women in Political Science, UC Berkeley	2020–2021
Graduate Student Coordinator , Comparative Politics Colloquium, UC Berkeley	2020–2021
Research Associate , Center for the Politics of Development	2018–Present

Research and Professional Experience

University of California, Berkeley

2019; 2020; 2022–2023; 2025

Graduate Student Researcher

- **Cecilia Mo** (Jan.–Aug. 2025; United States): cleaned and analyzed survey-experiment data on gender bias in U.S. presidential elections.
- **Cecilia Mo** (Sept. 2022–May 2023; Nigeria): developed survey instruments and training curricula for the *Metaketa Women's Groups RCT*; coordinated with Innovations for Poverty Action and ActionAid, including fieldwork in Abuja.
- **Cecilia Mo** (Summer 2020; Nepal): *Natural Disasters and Political Trust*; reviewed comparative scholarship on disasters and political trust.
- **Cecilia Mo** (Summer 2020): *Decision Dilemmas*; analyzed online survey-experiment data in Stata.
- **Alison Post** (Spring 2019; Brazil, India, and Indonesia): analyzed public-opinion data on city size, political attitudes, and participation in R.

World Bank

2022; 2023–2024

Short-Term Consultant

- **South Asia Region Gender Innovation Lab (SARGIL)** (Apr. 2023–Sept. 2024): research on women's economic empowerment in South Asia, including work contributing to an evidence-guided policy toolkit on Pakistan.
- **Vijayendra Rao** (Jan.–Feb. 2022): conducted a comparative literature review on women's self-help groups in developing countries.

Precision Development (PxD), Gujarat

June–Dec. 2022

Research Consultant

- With the SEWA Cooperative Federation, designed and conducted focus groups, participatory mapping, and mixed-methods research on rural women's well-being, livelihoods, and agricultural information needs.

IMAGO Global Grassroots

Sept. 2017–June 2018

Research and Strategy Consultant

- *Transform Rural India*: analyzed baseline data on women's political, economic, and social agency to inform the organization's theory of change.
- *Self-Employed Women's Association*: conducted qualitative research and designed and piloted a livelihoods survey for members across fourteen Indian states.

IDinsight India

Aug. 2015–2017

Manager

- Managed mixed-methods research and evaluations on women's livelihoods, agriculture, sanitation, and health for government and NGO partners, including the Andhra Pradesh Rural Inclusive Growth Programme.

Busara Center for Behavioral Economics, Kenya

June–Aug. 2014

Research Associate for Johannes Haushofer and Jeremy Shapiro

- Analyzed data and designed qualitative research on the effects of unconditional cash transfers on domestic violence; also designed behavioral interventions with ZanaAfrica Foundation, focusing on girls' education during puberty.

Affordable Housing Institute

Sept. 2012–June 2013

Associate

- Conducted research and project development on affordable housing, finance, and urban services across Latin America and Asia, including projects in Nicaragua, Mongolia, and Saudi Arabia.

J-PAL South Asia

Aug. 2011–2012

Research Associate for Karthik Muralidharan, Paul Niehaus, and Sandeep Sukhtankar

- Managed field operations, survey design, data quality, and government coordination for an 8,000-household RCT of biometric smartcards in Andhra Pradesh; conducted pilot research on biometric authentication in Bihar's public distribution system.

Fieldwork

Gujarat, India	2008; 2009; 2010; 2017; 2019; 2022; 2023; 2024
Abuja, Nigeria	2022
Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, and Jharkhand, India	2019
Delhi, India	2016–2017
Andhra Pradesh, India	2011–2012; 2015–2016
Kathmandu and Okhaldunga, Nepal	2015
Nairobi and Kisumu, Kenya	2014
Granada, Nicaragua	2013
Bihar, India	2011
Rajasthan, India	2010

Language Proficiency

English (native proficiency)
Gujarati (native proficiency)
Hindi (advanced proficiency)
Spanish (intermediate proficiency)